

Chad

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 6, 1959 **Usage:** National and Civil

The flag combines two Pan-African colors—red and yellow, with two colors from the French *Tricolore*—blue and red



Red recalls the blood shed for independence

Yellow symbolizes the sun and deserts

Blue symbolizes the sky and waters of the south

Africa



Chad became an autonomous republic in 1958 and for two years joined with Niger, Ivory Coast and Dahomey in the informal Sahel-Benin Union.

The flag is a combination of the Pan-African colors popularized by Ghana, and those of the French *Tricolore*, on which it is closely modeled. It was adopted for the autonomous republic and retained on independence in 1960. Despite many upheavals since independence the flag has not been changed.

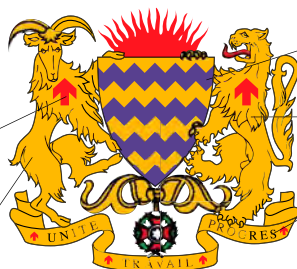
THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms dates from 1970, although Chad also has a seal (like many former French colonies), adopted in 1959. The arms is in the colors of the national flag and is supported by a lion and a wild goat. The medal below the shield is the badge of the National Order of Chad.

ARMS OF CHAD

The red symbol is for salt, the country's main mineral

A mountain goat represents the north of Chad



The wavy bars symbolize Lake Chad

The lion is symbolic of the south of the country

*The national motto—
“Unité, Travail, Progrès” (“Unity, Work, Progress”)*